

The Chief Inquisitor

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PRAVEEN SOOD, 59

DIRECTOR, CENTRAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION

BECAUSE he heads the country's top investigating agency, which has been handling several high-profile cases. The agency's performance has also improved in recent years with the conviction rate jumping from 68 per cent in 2021 to 75 per cent last year

BECAUSE like the ED, the CBI under him can alter the political equation. In the past five years, the CBI has registered a total of 56 cases against MPs/ MLAs of 11 parties, including the BJP

HIGHER STUDIES **The IIT Delhi alumnus took a sabbatical in 2003 to pursue Public Policy and Management courses at IIM Bangalore and Syracuse University, New York**

BECAUSE he has been the Centre's blue-eyed boy. Last year, as an Opposition leader, Karnataka Congress chief and Deputy Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar had called Sood *nalayak* (useless) and a BJP agent and sworn action against the IPS officer once his party came to power. Just as the Congress won the election, Sood was transferred out of Karnataka and given charge of the plum post

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MADHABI PURI BUCH, 57 →

CHAIRPERSON, SEBI

CAPITAL CONTROLLER

BECAUSE after taking over as Sebi's first female chief in March 2022, she set the ball rolling to make the regulator more developmental and facilitative in approach. She identified Sebi staff across departments to engage actively with industry and market participants to get their feedback and help formulate better policies

BECAUSE she believes that technology is a "magic bullet" that can help stakeholders in various areas of the market, including compliance, cost reduction and controls, among other things, and oversaw the transition of the Indian stock markets as one of the fastest in the world in terms of settlement

BECAUSE she spearheaded many initiatives, including those related to upgrading archaic laws—be it in share buyback, the role of mutual fund trustees, alternative investment finds, public issues or real estate investment trusts and investor grievance redressal mechanism

NON-IAS ROUTE **An alumna of St Stephen's College, Delhi, and IIM Ahmedabad, Puri Buch is the first non-IAS head of Sebi since 2002**



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